

book to try to make you feel bad about yourself. Stripping you of your self-confidence is their standard procedure. Don't let them.

## Deception Playbook

Every occupation has its tricks of the trade, and every profession has conferences and training seminars. Debt collectors are no different. They want to improve their methods for getting to you. There are Boy Scout camps; and then there are boys and girls, grown-up boys and girls, who go off to a type of boot camp for debt collectors. These are two totally different kinds of environments.

One group learns how to tie knots; the other group learns how to tie people up in knots. The debt collector campers are taught what to say and how to say it. They are highly practiced in when to fake sympathy, when to pretend to be mad, and when to go for the kill. They study methods of getting under your skin. They might even bite the heads off of chickens, but I can't say for sure.

They are well aware that anyone who has reached the collection process has no doubt suffered in some way – a job loss, a health crisis, a divorce, or even a death in the family. These guys and gals have no qualms, kicking a man when he's down.

Do not underestimate the lies and the deception of a debt collector. They will debase themselves like no other profession. A collection agent from San Diego was sent to prison in 2006 because he lied that he was a lawyer and that he could have the alleged debtors tossed in jail, unless they paid him. That is one of the oldest tricks in the Debt Deception Handbook, yet innocent people still fall for it. Don't fall for it!

## Common Threats

If the harasser calling you threatens to have you arrested, he is blowing smoke. You cannot go to jail over any alleged debt. Debt collection is a civil matter. Your alleged debt is not a criminal case, and you cannot go to jail. The "I will have you arrested!" threat is a bald-faced lie. I always used to say that the collectors should be thrown in jail for lying like that; it is refreshing to learn that it has happened. Hopefully it will be the start of a new trend.